

The Quiet Courier

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COVER STORY

The contradiction at the heart of OpenAI

OpenAI announced plans to invest substantial amounts of money in AI-related causes this year through its nonprofit, increasing its philanthropic efforts months after restructuring with a new for-profit arm.

Sean Rameswaram · Vox

| **N**ikolas Kokovlis/NurPhoto/Getty Images

Big changes are happening at OpenAI. On Wednesday, the company announced that it would be shutting down their AI video creation app Sora only a couple months after its launch. In October, OpenAI completed a massive restructure of its organization that shakes the very foundations it was built on.

OpenAI, which powers ChatGPT, among other AI products, was originally founded purely as a nonprofit. Now it has a for-profit arm. According to OpenAI CEO Sam Altman, the nonprofit will still guide the work of the for-profit side to ensure that artificial intelligence works for the “benefit of all humanity.” On top of that, the OpenAI Foundation, would be in charge of (theoretically) \$180 billion, making it one of the largest charitable organizations in the world.

Catherine Bracy, founder of the nonprofit Tech Equity, thinks this restructuring is a blatant attempt to free up the for-profit wing to act like any other AI company. She argues that OpenAI’s for-profit wing will only ever act for the benefit of its investors. Bracy believes the OpenAI Foundation is merely a glorified and toothless corporate social responsibility arm. We reached out to OpenAI for comment and did not receive a response.

Bracy spoke with Today, Explained host Sean Rameswaram about the legality of OpenAI’s new structure and her concerns about how this all might shake out. An excerpt of their conversation, edited for length and clarity, is below.

We worked together back in the day and then kind of went out of touch with each other for a few years. Then, when I was writing a book about ven-

ture capital, I was really interested in open AI’s nonprofit model. Sam had been very explicit that the reason they founded OpenAI as a nonprofit was to put the technology at arm’s length from investors because they knew investors would exploit it in a way that would make this technology — which they thought was very dangerous — actually live up to that potential danger.

So I wanted to talk to him about the decision-making process behind that. And he was very forthcoming about that being the explicit reason why OpenAI was founded as a nonprofit. They put a lot of thought and capacity and energy into creating this [nonprofit] governance structure that would protect the technology from the whims of investors, the [profit-generating] imperatives that investors put on technology companies.

And when you found out that Open AI was restructuring and going to try to have it both ways — mission-driven nonprofit, but also money-driven for-profit — what was your reaction?

Disappointment. I would say that was my initial reaction. And then the secondary response was, Well, what can we do about this? And many of us came together into this coalition that really started asking questions about the responsibility of the nonprofit and the responsibility of the attorney general of California to enforce nonprofit law. And things kind of went from there.

I run a nonprofit. In the tax code, that means that my organization does not need to pay taxes, but in return for that tax exemption, we are required to operate in service of a public service mission.

Our mission is to ensure that the tech industry is creating opportunity for everybody. OpenAI's nonprofit mission is to ensure that AI develops for the benefit of all of humanity. And legally, Sam Altman is required to prioritize OpenAI's mission above all else.

class="has-text-align-none">So when they decided they were going to split the nonprofit from the for-profit, they found that actually legally they could not do that without divesting the intellectual property that the nonprofit owned, including all of the intellectual property that was created that underlies the ChatGPT model, and the equity stake that the nonprofit owned in the for-profit company.

class="has-text-align-none">I think they looked at that price tag and they said, That's not a price we're willing to pay . And so instead of splitting the nonprofit from the for-profit, they decided to continue down this path of nonprofit ownership, which in my mind is completely untenable, unsustainable, and irreconcilable.

class="has-text-align-none">And actually what they're doing is just daring the attorney general to hold them accountable for it. I think they think they're too big to be held accountable and they need the AG [of California] to assume that he will not win a case. And that's what they've done. They've loaded up on lawyers and they are making a bet that the AG will not pursue this in any way that's actually meaningful.

class="has-text-align-none"> Okay. So if I'm following you, despite the fact that OpenAI has split itself into a for-profit arm and a not-for-profit arm, their not-for-profit mission still overrides everything they do. And because of that, they are violating California law — because there's no way that the nonprofit interests are ever going to be primary in their business .

class="has-text-align-none">Right. I think, as the kids would say, they're playing in our faces. They expect us to take their word that as they operate, as they make deals with the Defense Department to develop autonomous weapons and surveillance systems on American citizens, as they battle parents in court whose children have committed suicide due to conversations that these kids were having with their chatbots, they expect us to believe that the nonprofit mission is being prioritized over the profit motivation of the company.

class="has-text-align-none">We all know that OpenAI's overriding priority is to “win” the AI race. It's to beat out the competition in the marketplace, and it's to establish the biggest AI company they can create. To the extent that the nonprofit mission ever comes into tension with that, the company will always prioritize profits over the mission.

class="has-text-align-none">A law is only as good as its enforcement. And I think if there's one rule of Silicon Valley, it is to ask forgiveness and not permission. I think they said, You know, this is worth it. There's enough money on

the line for us to just break the law and do the PR work and the lobbying work and the other work that we need to do to ensure that these laws will never be enforced against us .

class="has-text-align-none">Well, here's the thing. They announced this week a list of priorities that the foundation would be investing in. They listed as one of their priorities, Alzheimer's research. My mother is currently dying of Alzheimer's. I have one copy of the gene that puts me at extreme risk of developing Alzheimer's when I'm older. So I pray every day that AI helps us find a solution to Alzheimer's fast enough that I can benefit from it, that my family can benefit from it.

class="has-text-align-none">But let me ask you a question. What happens, do you think, if the research that's funded by OpenAI's Foundation finds that actually Anthropic's models are better at drug discovery or scientific breakthroughs than ChatGPT or any of OpenAI's other models? What does it mean for the independence of scientific research, if all of this research is funded by an entity that has an irreconcilable conflict of interest?

“We do not have to take these companies at their word that they know best how to govern this technology. We should have bigger imaginations about what's possible.”

class="has-text-align-none">We would not accept the science around nicotine that tobacco companies were funding. We do not accept the science around alcohol addiction that the alcohol companies fund. We do not accept the science around sugared beverages from the soda industry. And we should not accept that this scientific research is funded by an entity that has a vested financial interest in the outcome.

class="has-text-align-none">And that is why it is so critically important that the OpenAI Foundation actually be independent, that it have an independent board, that it can deploy its resources independently, that the research that it is funding is independent.

class="has-text-align-none"> Do you still think that we're maybe better off that OpenAI says that they want to give billions away to better society — than say Anthropic, Google, maybe having some pledges to give money away, but not nearly as much?

class="has-text-align-none">Well, Google has a corporate foundation. It's called Google.org. And I expect in this structure with the tension and the conflict of interest that the OpenAI Foundation has, that it will operate much more like Google.org, which is essentially an arm of the marketing department, a corporate social responsibility program that gives money to innocuous groups — but will never do anything that undercuts Google's priorities.

class="has-text-align-none">I think if you read between the lines of open AI's press release, the work they say they want to continue doing with community funding is all about convincing people about the importance and value and benefit

in using AI. I mean, that's a market building opportunity for them. That's not actually anything that's going to ensure that AI is developed for the benefit of humanity. And so, no, I don't think that they're going to operate any differently than any of the other companies' corporate social responsibility arms. That's essentially what they have built here.

This is the fight of our time. AI is not inevitable. The way it develops is not inevitable. And we do not have to take these companies at their word that they know best how to govern this technology. We should have bigger imaginations about what's possible. And if anything, this should give us more energy and motivation to fix what's broken about our democracy than to just sit back and let billionaires control our future.

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FRONT PAGE

4 Business Ideas That Changed the World: Shareholder Value

Harvard Business Review

The idea that maximizing shareholder value takes legal and practical precedence above all else first came to prominence in the 1970s. The person who arguably did the most to advance the idea was the business school professor Michael Jensen, who wrote in *Harvard Business Review* and elsewhere that CEOs pursue their own interests at the expense of shareholders' interests. Among other things, he argued for stock-based incentives that would neatly align CEO and shareholder interests.

Shareholder primacy rapidly became business orthodoxy. It dramatically changed how and how much executives are compensated. And it arguably distorted capitalism for a generation or more. Critics have long charged that maximizing shareholder value ultimately just encourages CEOs and shareholders to feather their own nests at the expense of everything else: jobs, wages and benefits, communities, and the environment.

The past few years have seen a backlash against shareholder capitalism and the rise of so-called stakeholder capitalism. After reigning supreme for half a century, is shareholder value maximization on its way out?

4 Business Ideas That Changed the World is a special series from HBR IdeaCast. Each week, an HBR editor talks to world-class scholars and experts on the most influential ideas of HBR's first 100 years, such as disruptive innovation, scientific management, and emotional intelligence.

Discussing shareholder value with HBR editor in chief Adi Ignatius are:

Lynn Paine, professor at Harvard Business School
Mihir Desai, professor at Harvard Business School
Carola Frydman, professor at Kellogg School of Management

Further reading:

HBR: CEO Incentives—It's Not How Much You Pay, But How, by Michael C. Jensen and Kevin J. Murphy
New York Times: A Friedman doctrine-- The Social Responsibility Of Business Is to Increase Its Profits, by Milton Friedman
HBR: The Error at the Heart of Corporate Leadership, by Joseph L. Bower and Lynn S. Paine
U. S. Business Roundtable: Statement on the Purpose of a Corporation, 2019

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FEATURES

Chinese Traffic to time.gif

Dennis Felsing

Nearly two years ago I posted this endless GIF that always shows the current time in UTC:

Now looking at my GoAccess dashboard I can see that it is picking up in popularity rather suddenly:

But strangely I can't find anything about time.gif being linked on the web. So this might just be an attempted Denial of Service (DoS) attack? At least that would be something I am familiar with from the DDNet direction, but it's certainly strange on HookRace. But instead of simply shutting down time.gif I decided to try to find out who is accessing it and whether I can keep the server up.

Let's look into the nginx logs, since I use nginx to proxy the requests to the Haskell program. There I see about 40 new requests per second looking like this:

```
class="highlight"> hookrace.net 123.185. XXX. XXX - - [21/May/2019:21:21:27 +0200] "GET /time.gif HTTP/2.0" 200 3335 "XXX" "Mozilla/5.0 (Linux; Android 8.1.0; V1818A Build/OPM1.171019.026; wv) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Version/4.0 Chrome/66.0.3359.126 MQQBrowser/6.2 TBS/044681 Mobile Safari/537.36 MMWEBID/XXX MicroMessenger/7.0.4.1420(0x2700043A) Process/tools NetType/WIFI Language/zh_CN" 8.055
```

```
hookrace.net 111.62. XXX. XXX - - [21/May/2019:21:21:27 +0200] "GET /time.gif HTTP/2.0" 200 32061 "XXX" "Mozilla/5.0 (Linux; Android 5.1; OPPO A59s Build/LMY47I; wv) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Version/4.0 Chrome/66.0.3359.126 MQQBrowser/6.2 TBS/044704 Mobile Safari/537.36 MMWEBID/XXX MicroMessenger/7.0.4.1420(0x2700043B) Process/tools NetType/WIFI Language/zh_CN" 89.256
```

```
hookrace.net 111.29. XXX. XXX - - [21/May/2019:21:21:27 +0200] "GET /time.gif HTTP/2.0" 200 543830 "XXX" "Mozilla/5.0 (Linux; Android 7.1.1; OPPO R11 Build/NMF26X; wv) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Version/4.0 Chrome/66.0.3359.126 MQQBrowser/6.2 TBS/044704 Mobile Safari/537.36 MMWEBID/XXX MicroMessenger/7.0.4.1420(0x2700043A) Process/tools NetType/WIFI Language/zh_CN" 1540.238
```

```
hookrace.net 112.2. XXX. XXX - - [21/May/2019:21:21:27 +0200] "GET /time.gif HTTP/2.0" 200 172102 "XXX" "Mozilla/5.0 (Linux; Android 8.1.0; V1816A Build/OPM1.171019.011; wv) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Version/4.0 Chrome/66.0.3359.126 MQQBrowser/6.2 TBS/044611 Mobile Safari/537.36 MMWEBID/XXX MicroMessenger/7.0.4.1420(0x2700043A) Process/tools NetType/WIFI Language/zh_CN" 492.600
```

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hookrace.net 123.13. XXX. XXX - - [21/May/2019:21:21:27 +0200] "GET /time.gif HTTP/2.0" 200 1275 "XXX" "Mozilla/5.0 (Linux; Android 9; LYA-AL00 Build/HUAWEILYA-AL00L; wv) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like
```

```
Gecko) Version/4.0 Chrome/66.0.3359.126 MQQBrowser/6.2 TBS/044704 Mobile Safari/537.36 MMWEBID/XXX MicroMessenger/7.0.4.1420(0x2700043A) Process/tools NetType/WIFI Language/zh_CN" 1.888
```

```
hookrace.net 117.91. XXX. XXX - - [21/May/2019:21:21:27 +0200] "GET /time.gif HTTP/2.0" 200 4684 "XXX" "Mozilla/5.0 (iPhone; CPU iPhone OS 12_1_4 like Mac OS X) AppleWebKit/605.1.15 (KHTML, like Gecko) Mobile/16D57 MicroMessenger/7.0.3(0x17000321) NetType/WIFI Language/zh_CN" 12.123
```

I checked a few IP addresses and they were all in mobile networks, not data centers. The user agent containing MicroMessenger and MQQBrowser indicates that the source of the traffic are WeChat and/or QQ, popular chinese chat apps.

id="quantifying-the-traffic">Quantifying the Traffic

For reference, the system I'm running on is a simple Debian based VPS with 2 threads and 2 GB of RAM that also functions as the main server for DDNet's website , database and my HookRace blog.

I already had to do some scaling when posting the initial blog post on Hacker News , optimizing the Haskell application itself to use LZW encoding in the GIF frames, to properly clean up connections to prevent any memory leaks and disable buffering in nginx's config.

But the current level of traffic is on a different scale with 2.4 million hits on time.gif in the last 23 hours (30 hits per second) resulting in 113 GB of data being transferred. And many of those connections don't finish quickly, instead they linger for seconds, minutes or even hours.

Using `lsuf -i | grep Time | wc -l` I can see that there are about 6000 people downloading the GIF at peak times, causing up to 30 Mbit/s of outgoing traffic with 7000 packets/second incoming and the same number outgoing. The DDNet server statistics lets me monitor this nicely (related blog article):

Network

Packets

CPU

id="keeping-up-with-the-traffic">Keeping Up with the Traffic

Regenerating the ranks pages of DDNet usually causes the main CPU load on the server, which can be seen in the above CPU graph as spikes. This task is already set to only run when the server is below a specified load, so that more essential tasks have priority.

The first new problem was nginx running into a limit of 768 worker_connections:

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Emerson on Talent vs. Character, Our Resistance to Change, and the Key to True Personal Growth

Maria Popova · *The Marginalian (Brain Pickings)*

“People wish to be settled; only as far as they are unsettled is there any hope for them.”

“Cut short of the floundering and you’ve cut short the possible creative outcomes,” Denise Shekerjian wrote in contemplating the capacity for “staying loose” that many MacArthur geniuses have in common. “Cheat on the chaotic stumbling-about, and you’ve robbed yourself of the raw stuff that feeds the imagination.” And yet part of the human paradox is that even in the face of overwhelming evidence for this uncomfortable truth, despite full intellectual awareness of it, we continue to seek certainty and resist change, stunting our personal growth with stubborn self-righteousness and staunch defiance of the very discomfort from which self-transcendence springs.

From Ralph Waldo Emerson’s *Essays and Lectures* (public library ; free download) — the same indispensable volume that gave us the great philosopher on the two essential requirements of true friendship — comes a layered and immeasurably insightful 1841 essay titled “*Circles*,” exploring the pillars of personal growth and how we can learn to stop resisting the very things that help us transcend our self-imposed limitations.

A century and a half before psychologists examined “the backfire effect” of our ideological stubbornness, Emerson considers how we arrive at our beliefs and why we have such a hard time with the uncomfortable luxury of changing our minds :

The key to every man is his thought. Sturdy and defying though he look, he has a helm which he obeys, which is the idea after which all his facts are classified. He can only be reformed by showing him a new idea which commands his own. The life of man is a self-evolving circle, which, from a ring imperceptibly small, rushes on all sides outwards to new and larger circles, and that without end. The extent to which this generation of circles, wheel without wheel, will go, depends on the force or truth of the individual soul. For it is the inert effort of each thought, having formed itself into a circular wave of circumstance ... to heap itself on that ridge, and to solidify and hem in the life. But if the soul is quick and strong, it bursts over that boundary on all sides, and expands another orbit on the great deep, which also runs up into a high wave, with attempt again to stop and to bind. But the heart refuses to be imprisoned; in its first and narrowest pulses, it already tends outward with a vast force, and to immense and innumerable expansions.

The balance of steadfastness and spontaneity that jazz legend Bill Evans saw as necessary for his art, Emerson sees as necessary for the art of personal development:

Let me remind the reader that I am only an experimenter. Do not set the least value on what I do, or the least discredit

on what I do not, as if I pretended to settle any thing as true or false. I unsettle all things. No facts are to me sacred; none are profane; I simply experiment, an endless seeker... Yet this incessant movement and progression which all things partake could never become sensible to us but by contrast to some principle of fixture or stability in the soul.

In a sentiment that Bertrand Russell would come to echo nearly a century later in his ten timeless commandments of learning — “Do not fear to be eccentric in opinion, for every opinion now accepted was once eccentric.” — Emerson considers our resistance to change, both as individuals and as a culture:

Every ultimate fact is only the first of a new series... The new statement is always hated by the old, and, to those dwelling in the old, comes like an abyss of skepticism.

[...]

In nature every moment is new; the past is always swallowed and forgotten... Nothing is secure but life, transition, the energizing spirit. No love can be bound by oath or covenant to secure it against a higher love. No truth so sublime but it may be trivial to-morrow in the light of new thoughts. People wish to be settled; only as far as they are unsettled is there any hope for them.

Life is a series of surprises.

But Emerson’s most pressing point has to do with how this courage for embracing uncertainty and change — especially unwelcome change — is the foundation of what we call character:

The difference between talents and character is adroitness to keep the old and trodden round, and power and courage to make a new road to new and better goals. Character makes an overpowering present; a cheerful, determined hour, which fortifies all the company, by making them see that much is possible and excellent that was not thought of. Character dulls the impression of particular events. When we see the conqueror, we do not think much of any one battle or success... The great man is not convulsible or tormentable; events pass over him without much impression. People say sometimes, ‘See what I have overcome; see how cheerful I am; see how completely I have triumphed over these black events.’ Not if they still remind me of the black event. True conquest is the causing the calamity to fade and disappear, as an early cloud of insignificant result in a history so large and advancing.

He returns to the notion of life’s self-evolving circle:

The one thing which we seek with insatiable desire is to forget ourselves, to be surprised out of our propriety, to lose our sempiternal memory, and to do something without knowing how or why; in short, to draw a new circle. Nothing great was ever achieved without enthusiasm. The way of life is wonderful: it is by abandonment. The great moments

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standard-article(title: ["Hitting Iran hard": Trump soft-sells "troops on the ground" via Fox News], author: [Alex Galbraith], source-name: [Salon], images: (), paragraphs: ([Donald Trump seems to know that deploying ground troops to Iran to continue a historically unpopular war will hurt his standing. The president turned to television hosts to float the idea on Saturday, promoting Fox News host Mark Levin before the anchor promoted a small-scale invasion.], ["Watch Mark Levin interview of Brilliant Marc Thiessen tonight," Trump wrote on Truth Social . "Will discuss the importance of hitting Iran, HARD!!!"], [Viewers who took the president's advice were pitched on sending small teams of "specialized" soldiers to Iran, with the hopes of removing enriched uranium from the country.], ["Why would we need troops on the ground? Well, there's a lot of reasons—and we wouldn't need 300,000 of them," Levin said. "[Trump's] not talking about sending regular Army infantry in by the hundreds of thousands. The men he's talking about, the units he's talking about, they are specialized."], [As the war in Iran stretches past the one-month mark, it's unclear whether Trump's hinting indicates a real desire for escalation or a negotiation tactic. Pentagon insiders who spoke to Salon said that the president "might actually think that he can threaten to send in troops without ever having to do it," betting on the U. S. superior firepower to cause Iran to fold.], ["We wouldn't be the first to mistakenly think a smarter bomb will keep us from putting boots on the ground," the source said.], [style="text-align: center;"]> Start your day with essential news from Salon.], [The speaker of the Iranian parliament warned U. S. officials against the idea of an invasion on Sunday, saying that their military was "waiting" for a "ground attack."], ["Our men are waiting for the arrival of the American soldiers on the ground to set them on fire and punish their regional allies once and for all," said Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf.], [Watch Levin's pitch via YouTube below:], [Trump's Iran war has no clear endgame], [Saudi Arabia tells Trump to seize "historic moment" and continue war on Iran: report], [How Iran emasculated JD Vance], [The post "Hitting Iran hard": Trump soft-sells "troops on the ground" via Fox News appeared first on Salon.com .],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 373, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Will the U.S. Enter a Recession in 2026? Here's What the Data Suggests.], author: [Katie Brockman], source-name: [The Motley Fool], images: (), paragraphs: ([Recession fears are back, and stock prices continue to slide. The S&P 500 (SNPINDEX: ^GSPC) is down more than 6% over the past month alone, and the tech-heavy Nasdaq Composite (NASDAQINDEX: ^IXIC) just entered correction territory by falling 10% from its peak earlier this year.], [Perhaps the worst part of all of this volatility, however, is the uncertainty it's causing. Will the economy worsen? Will the market crash? How long will it take for it to recover? While it's impossible to answer these questions with any certainty right now, here's what the data suggests about the future.], [Continue reading],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 103, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

The men he's talking about, the units he's talking about, they are specialized.

Alex Galbraith

standard-article(title: [How To Talk Yourself Up (Without Turning People Off)], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Leslie John, associate professor at Harvard Business School, has done some deep research into the ways that people self-promote in their professional lives and identified what works and what doesn't. She says it is possible tout your own accomplishments without annoying your colleagues, if you do it at the right time or enlist others to boast on your behalf. She notes that many common workarounds – such as humblebragging – are highly ineffective and advises people to not only look for more

standard-article(title: [Open Digital Platforms to Spur Innovation], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([As the novel coronavirus surfaced in Wuhan in 2019, Chinese officials called for mobile isolation wards. Haier Group partnered with suppliers to design and construct units quickly, thanks to the openness of the leading manufacturer's digital platforms. Unlike Haier, many companies have tightly regulated, siloed platforms. Georgetown Professor Kasra Ferdows says more companies can unlock innovations by extending their platforms to facilitate a broader range of collaborations. He breaks down how Haier capitalizes on

natural opportunities to self-promote but also try to present balanced views of themselves. She’s full of tips you can put to work, even in virtual settings. John is the author of the HBR article “Savvy Self-Promotion.”],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 118, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Brain Tech Is Getting Really Good. Here’s What Managers Need to Know], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([What seemed like science fiction for decades is now a reality: companies are selling wearable tech and monitoring devices that can sense people’s brain activity. Neurotechnology opens incredible opportunities for new products and safer workplaces. It also raises huge red flags for privacy and ethics. And managers and organizational leaders are on the front lines of these dilemmas, says Duke University School of Law professor Nita Farahany. She explains the commercial products based on neurotechnology, the impact on workers and organizations, and the need for regulations and corporate policies. Farahany wrote the book The Battle for Your Brain: Defending the Right to Think Freely in the Age of Neurotechnology.],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 109, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Digital Collegium 2025], author: [Erik Runyon], source-name: [Erik Runyon], images: (), paragraphs: ([My presentation for Digital Collegium 2025 was an overview of many recent and forthcoming additions to the web platform, specifically HTML and CSS.], [id=“description”>Description], [id=“roll-for-sanity-surviving-the-ever-expanding-web-feature-bestiary”>Roll for sanity: Surviving the ever-expanding web feature bestiary], [Are you, brave front-end adventurer, feeling your sanity slipping as the Ever-Expanding Web Feature Bestiary grows with each browser update? Have you encountered strange and powerful creatures like “popovers” and “functions” and wondered how to tame them?], [Join us on this perilous quest as we delve into the depths of the latest web platform additions. We will examine these fearsome beasts, dissecting their syntax and revealing their practical applications in the realm of higher ed. We’ll learn to harness their power for real-world encounters, and even glimpse into the future, where new and even more formidable creatures lurk.], [Prepare your character sheets, sharpen your coding blades and roll for sanity as we navigate this challenging and ever-evolving landscape. Will you emerge victorious, a master of the modern web, or will the Bestiary claim your mind?], [id=“presentation”>Presentation], [Conference presentation details], [Presentation/Code], [id=“links”>Links], [Interop 2025 Dashboard], [2026 interop proposals], [CSS Gap Decorations playground], [id=“keeping-up-with-new-features”>Keeping up with new features], [New to the web platform], [Kevin Powell (YouTube)],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 209, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

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Special Series: How Generative AI Changes Everything

Harvard Business Review

the expertise and resources of its ecosystem and rapidly exploits new business opportunities. Ferdows is a coauthor of the HBR article “How to Turn a Supply Chain Platform into an Innovation Engine.”],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 106, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [In Defense of Middle Management], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Middle managers are meant to serve as a go-between for leadership teams and individual contributors. But in large organizations, with many layers of hierarchy, some of these roles feel like bureaucratic bloat, which, in tighter economic times, makes them a target for elimination. Emily Field, a partner at McKinsey & Company, thinks in many cases that’s a mistake. She argues that most middle managers are critical to corporate performance and productivity, executive team insight, and employee well-being. The key is making sure their roles adapt to the times. Field is the coauthor, along with Bryan Hancock and Bill Schaninger, of the HBR article “Don’t Eliminate Your Middle Managers,” as well as the book Power to the Middle: Why Managers Hold the Keys to the Future of Work.],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 127, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Another Workplace Crisis: Loneliness], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Vivek Murthy, former U. S. Surgeon General, says that, even before the Covid-19 pandemic, we were facing another health crisis: loneliness. Studies show that, around the world, more people have been feeling a greater sense of social isolation, which has many negative affects, including increased blood pressure, reduced immune response, and decreased engagement and productivity at work. But organizations can be a place where people find a greater sense of belonging. Murthy wants us to take loneliness more seriously and focus on fostering the types of authentic connections – face-to-face and virtual – that we need to combat it. He’s the author of the book “Together: The Healing Power of Human Connection in a Sometimes Lonely World.”],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 116, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

Generative AI seems to be everywhere right now, but what do you actually need to know?

HBR IdeaCast is cutting through the noise in the special series How Generative AI Changes Everything. How will this new technology upend workforce productivity? What impact will it have on creativity and innovation? How can you build an internal culture that uses generative artificial intelligence and adopt it effectively in your organization? What could it mean for your company's strategy?

Hosted by HBR editor in chief Adi Ignatius and HBR editor Amy Bernstein, you'll hear directly from the business leaders at the leading edge, as well as experts, who in some cases are questioning the ethics and speed of this rollout.

If you want to understand what this technology means for your organization and how you can lead effectively, listen every Thursday in May in the HBR IdeaCast feed, after the regular Tuesday episode.

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ANALYSIS

Fragments: March 10

Martin Fowler

Tech firm fined \$1.1m by California for selling high-school students' data

I agree with Brian Marick's response

No such story should be published without a comparison of the fine to the company's previous year revenue and profits, or valuation of last funding round. (I could only find a valuation of \$11.0M in 2017.)

We desperately need corporations' attitudes to shift from "lawbreaking is a low-risk cost of doing business; we get a net profit anyway" to "this could be a death sentence."

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Charity Majors gave the closing keynote at SRECon last year, encouraging people to engage with generative AI.

If I was giving the keynote at SRECon 2026, I would ditch the begrudging stance. I would start by acknowledging that AI is radically changing the way we build software. It's here, it's happening, and it is coming for us all.

Her agenda this year would be to tell everyone that they mustn't wait for the wave to crash on them, but to swim out to meet it. In particular, I appreciated her call to resist our confirmation bias:

The best advice I can give anyone is: know your nature, and lean against it.

If you are a reflexive naysayer or a pessimist, know that, and force yourself to find a way in to wonder, surprise and delight.

If you are an optimist who gets very excited and tends to assume that everything will improve: know that, and force yourself to mind real cautionary tales.

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In a comment to Kief Morris's recent article on Humans and Agents in Software Loops, in LinkedIn comments Renaud Wilsius may have coined another bit of terminology for the agent+programmer age

This completes the story of productivity, but it opens a new chapter on talent: The Apprentice Gap. If we move humans 'on the loop' too early in their careers, we risk a future where no one understands the 'How' deeply enough to build a robust harness. To manage the flywheel effectively, you still need the intuition that comes from having once been 'in the loop.' The next great challenge for CTOs isn't just Harness Engineering, it's 'Experience Engineering' for our junior developers in an agentic world.

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In hearing conversations about "the ralph loop", I often hear it in the sense of just letting the agents loose to run on their own. So it's interesting to read the originator of the ralph loop point out:

It's important to watch the loop as that is where your personal development and learning will come from. When you see a failure domain – put on your engineering hat and resolve the problem so it never happens again.

In practice this means doing the loop manually via prompting or via automation with a pause that involves having to press CTRL+C to progress onto the next task. This is still ralphing as ralph is about getting the most out how the underlying models work through context engineering and that pattern is GENERIC and can be used for ALL TASKS.

At the Thoughtworks Future of Software Development Retreat we were very concerned about cognitive debt. Watching the loop during ralphing is a way to learn about what the agent is building, so that it can be directed effectively in the future.

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Anthropic recently published a page on how AI helps break the cost barrier to COBOL modernization. Using AI to help migrate COBOL systems isn't a new idea to my colleagues, who shared their experiences using AI for this task over a year ago. While Anthropic's article is correct about the value of AI, there's more to the process than throwing some COBOL at an LLM.

The assumption that AI can simply translate COBOL into Java treats modernization as a syntactic exercise, as though a system is nothing more than its source code. That premise is flawed.

A direct translation would, in the best case scenario, faithfully reproduce existing architectural constraints, accumulated technical debt and outdated design decisions. It wouldn't address weaknesses; it would restate them in a different language.

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In practice, modernization is rarely about preserving the past in a new syntax. It's about aligning systems with current market demands, infrastructure paradigms, software supply chains and operating models. Even if AI were eventually capable of highly reliable code translation, blind conversion would risk recreating the same system with the same limitations, in another language, without a deliberate strategy for replacing or retiring its legacy ecosystem.

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Anders Hoff (inconvergent)

an LLM is a compiler in the same way that a slot machine is an ATM

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standard-article(title: [How Companies Can Tap Into Talent Clusters], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Bill Kerr, a professor at Harvard Business School, studies the increasing importance of talent clusters in our age of rapid technological advances. He argues that while talent and industries have always had a tendency to cluster, today's trend towards San Francisco, Boston, London and a handful of other cities is different. Companies need to react and tap into those talent pools, but moving the company to one isn't always an option. Kerr talks about the three main ways companies can access talent. He's the author of the HBR article "Navigating Talent Hot Spots," as well as the book "The Gift of Global Talent: How Migration Shapes Business, Economy & Society."],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 110, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Tried-and-True Networking Tips from Decades of Experience], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Twenty-five years ago, a Harvard Business School case study featured the exceptional networking practices of Silicon Valley entrepreneur and venture capitalist Heidi Roizen. This was before the rise of online social networks and the ubiquity of social media. But today, Roizen says that those developments have not fundamentally changed how she builds and maintains strong personal and professional relationships. Now a partner at Threshold Ventures and a lecturer at Stanford Graduate School of Business, she shares the biggest missteps that she sees people take. She also explains the impact of AI and remote work on networking, her most effective strategies for building relationships, and her frank advice for those just starting their careers.], [Roizen is subject of the HBS case study "Heidi Roizen."],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 123, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Could Your Company Benefit from Fastvertising?], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([It's harder than ever for companies to get their marketing messages in front of the right customers. One increasingly popular – but also risky – tactic is fastvertising, the rapid development of ads that tap into a cultural moment, aiming to increase brand relevance and awareness. Harvard Business School associate professor Ayelet Israeli shares pitch-perfect examples, including those from her coauthor, the actor Ryan Reynolds, and his marketing firm Maximum Effort. She explains the importance of timing, describes the talent, culture, and processes you need to succeed, and outlines how to extend the impact of these ads. Ayelet, along with Leonard Schlesinger, Matt Higgins, and Ryan Reynolds, wrote the HBR article "Marketing at the Speed of Culture."],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 117, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

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standard-article(title: [What Leaders Need to Know About a Looming Recession – and Other Global Threats], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Nouriel Roubini, professor emeritus at NYU's Stern School of Business, says that a confluence of trends – from skyrocketing public and private debt and bad monetary policies to demographic shifts and the rise of AI – are pushing the world toward catastrophe. He warns of those interconnected threats, but also has suggestions for how political and business leaders can prepare for and navigate through these challenges. He draws on decades of economic research as well as his experience accurately predicting, advising on, and observing responses to the 2008 global financial crisis, and he's the author of "Megathreats: Ten Dangerous Trends that Imperil our Future, and How to Survive Them."],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 109, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [A New Way to Combat Bias at Work], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Joan Williams, professor and the founding director of the Center for Work-Life Law at the University of California's Hastings College of the Law, says that it's extremely difficult for organizations to rid their workforces of the unconscious biases that can prevent women and minorities from advancing. But it's not so hard for individual managers to interrupt bias within their own teams. She offers specific suggestions for how bosses can shift their approach in four areas: hiring, meetings, assignments, and reviews/promotions. Leaders who employ these practices, she argues, are able to embrace and reap the advantages of diversity, even in the absence of larger organizational directives. Williams is the author of the HBR article "How the Best Bosses Interrupt Bias on Their Teams."],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 122, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Why You (and Your Company) Need to Experiment with ChatGPT Now], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([The online application ChatGPT and its integration into Microsoft search engines have put generative artificial intelligence technology in the hands of millions of people. Early adopters are using them in their daily jobs, and preliminary academic studies show big boosts in productivity. Managers can't sit on the sidelines, says Ethan Mollick, an associate professor of management at The Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania. He argues that companies urgently need to experiment with ChatGPT and eventually develop policies for it. He explains the breakthrough, some promising uses, open questions, and what the technology could mean for workers, companies, and the broader economy. Mollick wrote the HBR article "ChatGPT Is a Tipping Point for AI."],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 115, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

Sara Rathner, NerdWallet: class="nw-author-box-wp">

class="nw-author-box-wp-inner">

Sara Rathner writes for NerdWallet. Email: srathner@nerdwallet.com.

class="nw-originally-posted-link">The article 5 Things to Know About the Valero Credit Card originally appeared on NerdWallet.

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Amy Edmondson, professor at Harvard Business School, first identified the concept of psychological safety in work teams in 1999. Since then, she has observed how companies with a trusting workplace perform better. Psychological safety isn't about being nice, she says. It's about giving candid feedback, openly admitting mistakes, and learning from each other. And she argues that kind of organizational culture is increasingly important in the modern economy. Edmondson is the author of the new book "The Fearless Organization: Creating Psychological Safety in the Workplace for Learning, Innovation, and Growth."

Paresh Dave, Wired: A judge temporarily blocked the Trump administration's designation, clearing the way for Anthropic to keep doing business without the label starting next week.

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: At a time when 41% of us are considering quitting our jobs, it's time for us to understand why and what we can do about it. In this special series from HBR, we're looking at how to craft your current job around the work you really love. In this episode, we'll explain how to identify which tasks fit that bill and can lead you to a more fulfilling and successful career. IdeaCast co-host Alison Beard speaks with Marcus Buckingham, head of research on people and performance at the ADP Research Institute and author of the new book Love + Work.

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Greg Urban, anthropologist at the University of Pennsylvania, used to study indigenous tribes in Brazil. Now he hangs out in break rooms and boardrooms analyzing how people interact — and create and change culture — in organizations. He shares lessons and tips for managers to better understand and motivate their teams. Urban is the coauthor of the book "The Culture Puzzle: Harnessing the Forces that Drive Your Organization's Success."

Stefon Walters, The Motley Fool: It's hard to find a truly recession-proof stock, but some companies are better equipped to weather recessions than others. When it comes to digital payments, Visa (NYSE: V) and Mastercard (NYSE: MA) run a virtual duopoly, but one is much better positioned to endure a recession than the other.

If you had to choose between the two, my go-to would be Visa because its balance sheet is more rock-solid than Mastercard's.

class="caption">Image source: The Motley Fool.

Continue reading

Molly Higgins, Wired: Explore today's top DoorDash promo codes for \$25 off your first order, free delivery, and up to 50% off for existing customers.

Danielle Paquette, The Washington Post (national): Frankie Olivieri's decision to tinker with the classic cheesesteak was driven by a decades-long need to break free of his father's rigid ways.

Adrianna Adarme, A Cozy Kitchen: This Short Rib Ragu is deeply flavorful and impressive, but surprisingly low-maintenance. It's mostly hands-off thanks to a long oven...

(Read more...)

Tags: Dinner Dinner Party Pasta ragu short ribs

The post Slow-Braised Short Rib Ragu appeared first on A Cozy Kitchen .

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Zak Dychtwald, founder of the advisory firm Young China Group, believes that the perception of China as a copycat and not an innovator is outdated. Instead, he argues the willingness of Chinese consumers to try new things is powering the country's new innovation economy. Technology adoption rates in areas such as mobile payment are extremely high. He says non-Chinese companies can learn important lessons from this rapidly changing market and potentially use it to jump-start their own innovation engines. Dychtwald is the author of the HBR article "China's New Innovation Advantage."

Sergio De Simone, InfoQ: In a move to transform Android into an "agent-first" OS, Google has introduced new early beta features to support a task-centric model in which apps provide functional building blocks users leverage through AI agents or assistants to fulfill their goals.

By Sergio De Simone

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Even in difficult times, leadership must be about empathy, authenticity, fairness and service. That's according to Darren Walker, the outgoing CEO of the Ford Foundation, a nonprofit with an endowment of billions of dollars and a charge to reduce poverty and injustice. Drawing on his own upbringing in rural Texas to his time at the helm of one of the world's largest philanthropies, Walker explains how inequality erodes hope, why discomfort is essential for meaningful change, and how leaders can build the courage to speak honestly.

Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Alison Dachner, management professor at John Carroll University, and Erin Makarius, management professor at the University of Akron, say that an organization can become more competitive by implementing a stronger offboarding process. Their research shows that similar to the way universities maintain alumni networks, an offboarding strategy keeps former employees networked, which leads to more employee referrals, new business, expert consulting, or even re-employment. Dachner and Makarius wrote the HBR article "Turn Departing Employees into Loyal Alumni."

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